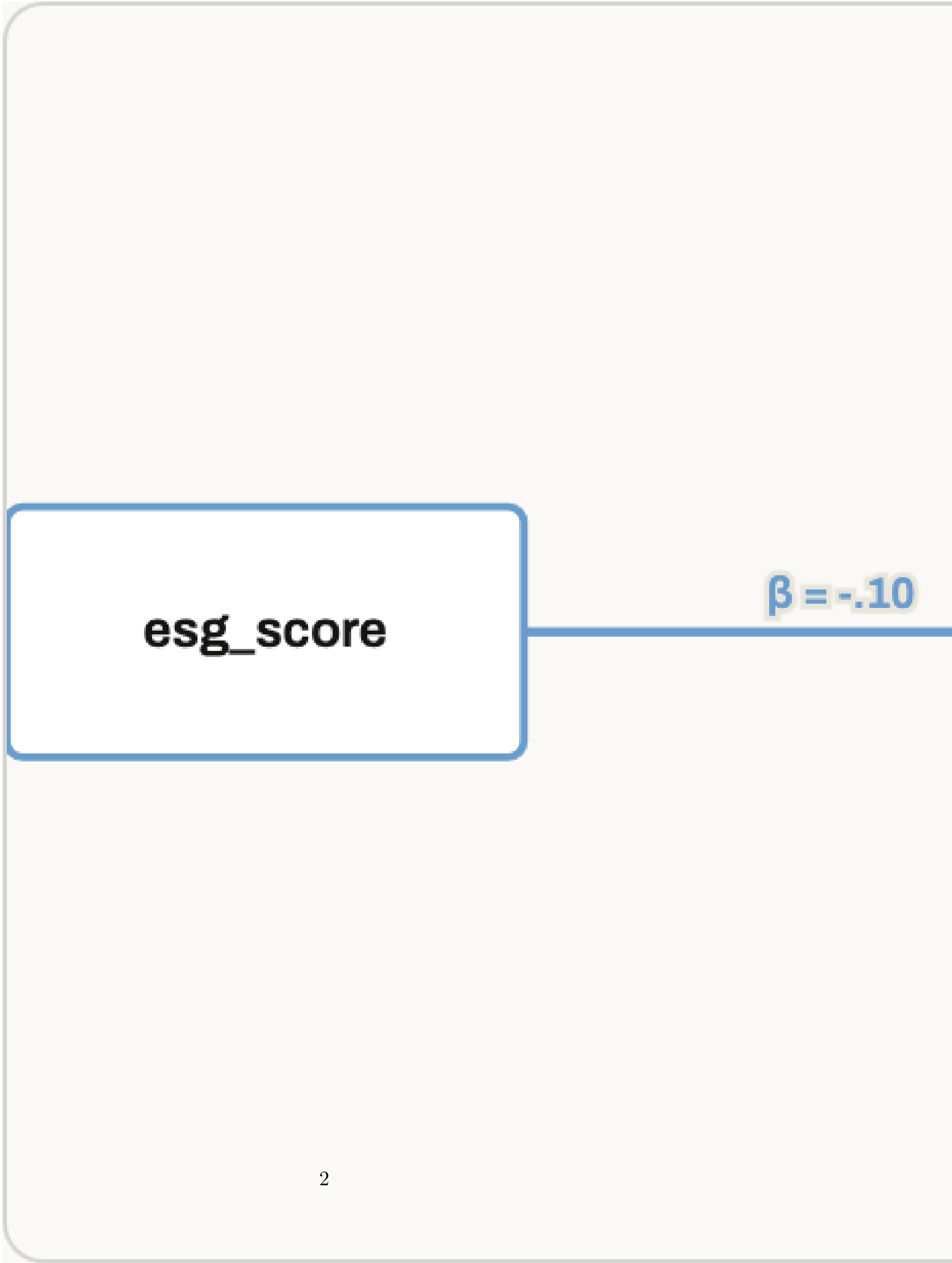
1 Path analysis

Path	B	SE	z	p	Std. β	95% CI	R^2
esg_score → norm_score	-0.10	0.05	-1.93	.054	$-.10$	[$-.20$, .00]	.01
norm_score → intent_score	0.25	0.05	5.30	$<.001$	.26	[.17, .35]	.17
esg_score → intent_score	0.35	0.04	7.82	$<.001$	.34	[.26, .42]	.17

Path	Estimate	SE	boot 95% CI	p
esg_score → norm_score → intent_score	-0.03	0.01	[-0.06, -0.00]	.077


esg_score
β = -.10

Path analysis estimates a system of regressions among observed variables at once, letting one variable be both an outcome and a predictor (mediation). Structural paths: each B is the unstandardized effect, Std. β the standardized effect, with z, p, and a 95% CI; R^2 is the variance explained in each endogenous variable. Indirect effects: the product of the paths through a mediator (e.g. X $\rightarrow$ M $\rightarrow$ Y), judged by its bootstrap 95% CI - an interval excluding 0 indicates mediation. When df = 0 the model is saturated (it reproduces the data exactly), so fit indices are not informative and are omitted; only with extra constraints (df $>$ 0) do global fit indices apply, and even then read RMSEA cautiously at small df / small N. All thresholds are heuristics, not pass/fail gates.

A path model fit to the observed variables; the indirect effect of X on Y through M was significant, bootstrap 95% CI excluding 0.

Statistical basis: Path model estimation (lavaan::sem, observed variables only) (Rosseel, Y. (2012). "lavaan: An R Package for Structural Equation Modeling." Journal of Statistical Software, 48(2), 1-36.); RMSEA interpreted cautiously at small df / small N for over-identified models (Kenny, D. A., Kaniskan, B., McCoach, D. B. (2015). "The performance of RMSEA in models with small degrees of freedom." Sociological Methods & Research, 44(3), 486-507.); Bootstrap percentile CIs for indirect (mediated) effects (MacKinnon, D. P., Lockwood, C. M., Williams, J. (2004). "Confidence limits for the indirect effect: Distribution of the product and resampling methods." Multivariate Behavioral Research, 39(1), 99-128.).